WAKE COUNTY
PUBLIC SCHOOL SYSTEM

# School Forms

## Staff Guide

Wake County Public School System
October 2026

For Staff and School Contact accounts

# Contents


## Getting started

- What School Forms does for you
- Signing in — Figure 1
- Finding your way around — Figure 2
- Reading system messages

## Forms and access

- Viewing the forms you can open — Figure 3
- Requesting access to a private form
- Tracking and withdrawing a request — Figure 4

## Your submissions queue

- The queue at a glance — Figure 5
- Filtering by status — Figure 6
- Filtering by form — Figure 7
- Choosing columns — Figure 8
- Showing archived submissions — Figure 9

## Filling in staff-only fields

- What staff-only fields are — Figure 10
- Filling in a field inline from the queue — Figures 11–12
- Filling in staff-only fields from submission details — Figure 13
- Which method should I use?

## Reviewing a submission

- The submission detail page — Figure 14
- Changing the status — Figure 15
- Editing a parent's answers — Figure 16
- Archiving and restoring

## Documents

- The Generated Documents list — Figure 17
- Opening a document — Figure 18

## Reports and export

- Building a report — Figure 19
- Selecting columns — Figure 20
- Grouping rows — Figure 21
- Exporting from the queue — Figure 22

## Your account


- Changing your password — Figures 23–24
- Signing out


## Reference


- Status meanings
- Field types
- "I can't see it"
- Troubleshooting

# 1. Getting started

## 1.1 What School Forms does for you

School Forms collects the forms parents fill in online and gives you a place to review them. As a staff member you can:

- See every submission for your school — or, if you are Staff rather than a School Contact, every school in your organization.
- Fill in the **staff-only fields** that parents never see.
- Move a submission through its statuses and edit an answer that was entered wrongly.
- Export what you see to a spreadsheet.

You cannot design forms, manage users, or change the site's settings — those belong to an administrator.

> **Staff and School Contact**
>
> This guide covers both roles. They use the same screens; the one consistent difference is that a **School Contact** is tied to a single school, so there is no **School** filter anywhere and every list contains only that school's submissions. Where that matters, the step says so.

## 1.2 Signing in

Open the School Forms address in your browser and sign in with the email address and password your administrator gave you.

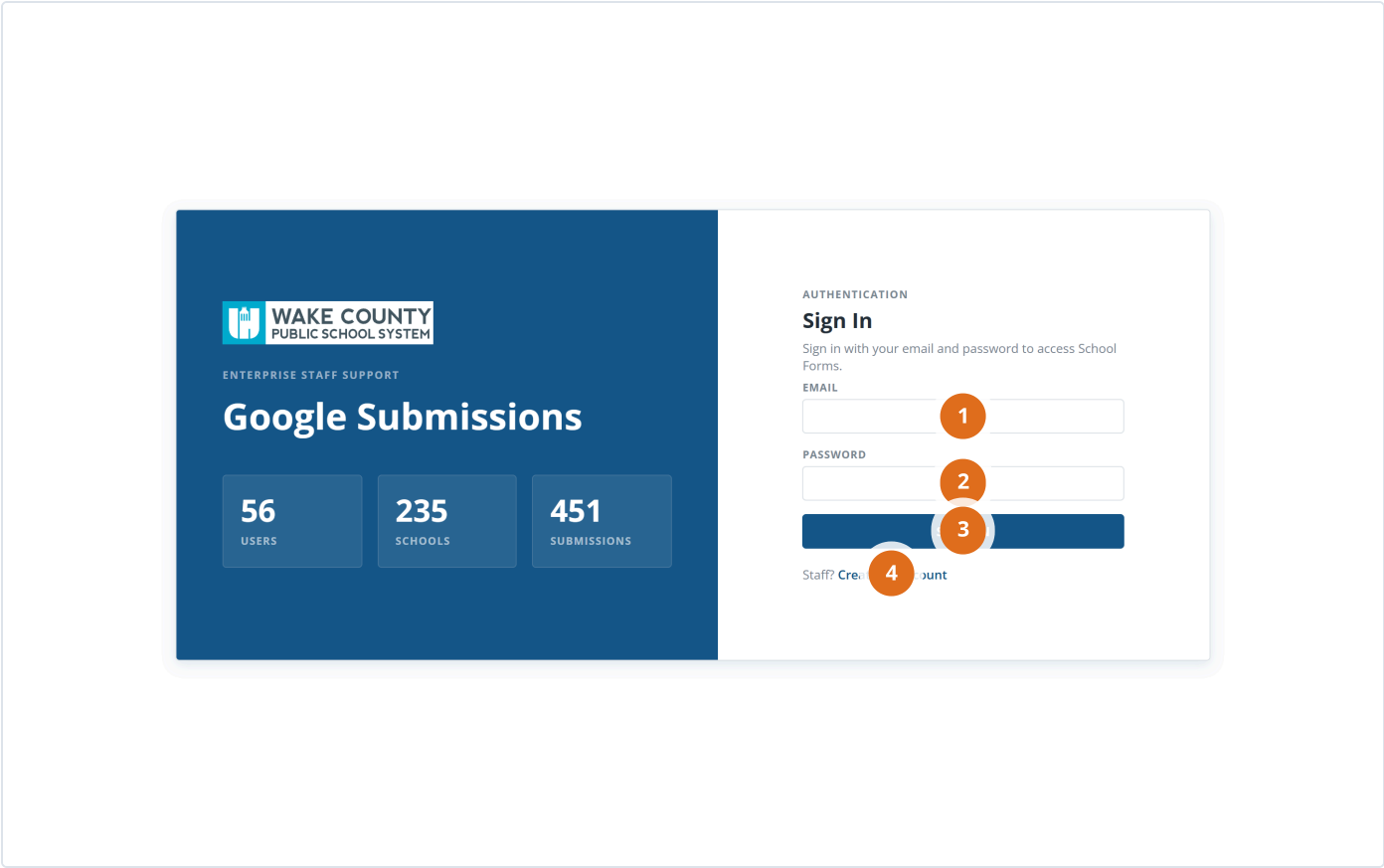



**Figure 1 — Signing in.**

1. **Email** — type the address you registered with.
2. **Password** — type your password. Both boxes are case-sensitive.
3. **Sign In** — click it once both boxes are filled in.
4. **Create an account** — only if you have never signed in before.

Your administrator chooses how the sign-in screen behaves, so it can appear in one of three ways:

| WHAT YOU SEE | WHAT TO DO |
|---|---|
| **Email** and **Password** boxes *(the normal screen)* | Type your email and password, then click **Sign In**. |
| **Organization** and **Test User** lists | Choose your organization, then your name, then click **Sign In**. No password is needed — this is a demonstration mode. |
| An amber maintenance message | Sign-in is switched off while the site is being updated. Try again later. |

**Tip**

New staff can click **Create an account** below the sign-in button. The form asks for your **Full Name**, **School**, **Email** and **Password**. Your account starts with Staff access; an administrator decides which forms you can open.

**If your password does not work**

Check that Caps Lock is off and that you are using the email address you registered with. There is no self-service "forgot password" link — ask an administrator to reset it. They can give you a temporary password, and the first time you sign in with it you are required to choose a new one. See 8.1 Changing your password.

## 1.3 Finding your way around

After you sign in you land on **Submissions**. The menu is closed so your work has the full width of the screen — click the menu button in the top-left corner to open it.

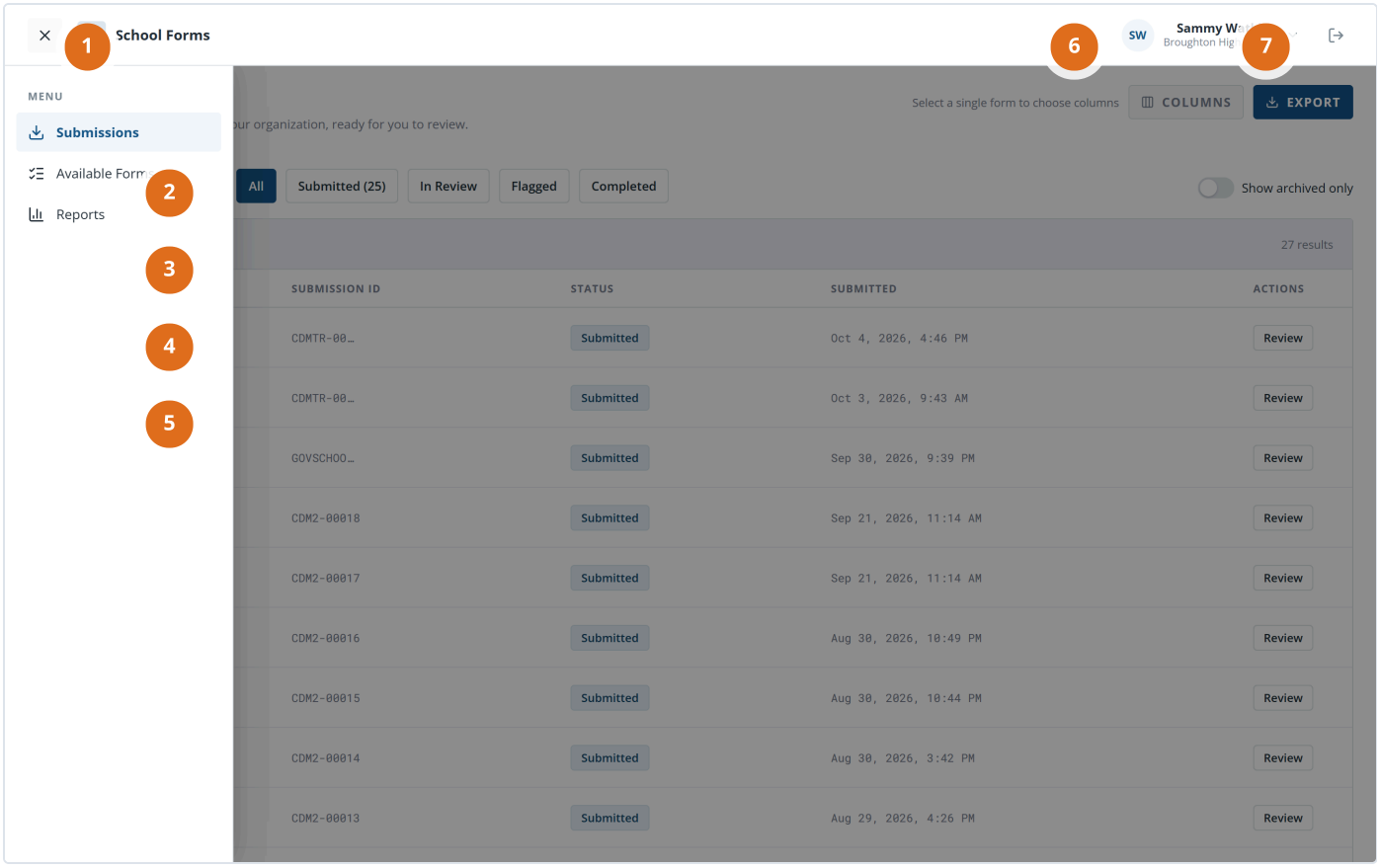



**Figure 2 — The menu, the account chip and the log-out button.**

1. Menu button — opens and closes this panel.
2. **Submissions** — your queue of everything waiting for review.
3. **Available Forms** — every form in your organization and which ones you can open.
4. **Documents** — Google Docs generated from submissions. Only appears if your administrator turned it on for your role.
5. **Reports** — build a filtered table and export it.
6. Your name — click it to open the account menu (**Change password**).
7. Log-out button.

The menu closes when you pick a section, click outside it, or press `Esc`.

> **If a menu item is missing**
>
> An administrator can hide **Available Forms** and **Reports** in **Settings** → **Menu Settings**, and **Documents** has its own per-role switch. A missing item is a setting, not a fault. See 9.3 "I can't see it".

## 1.4 Reading system messages

From time to time an administrator posts a notice to everyone, or to your role only. It appears as a banner at the top of the page content, above whatever you are working on.

- The **title** and **body** carry the message.
- A small badge shows the **audience** — for example *Everyone* or your role.
- Click the ✕ to dismiss it for yourself. Dismissing does not remove it for anyone else.

# 2. Forms and access

A form can be **public** (everyone in your organization can open it) or **private** (an administrator grants access one account at a time). This part shows you which forms you hold and how to ask for one you don't.

## 2.1 Viewing the forms you can open

Open the menu and choose **Available Forms**. The page lists every published form in your organization, grouped by your relationship to it.

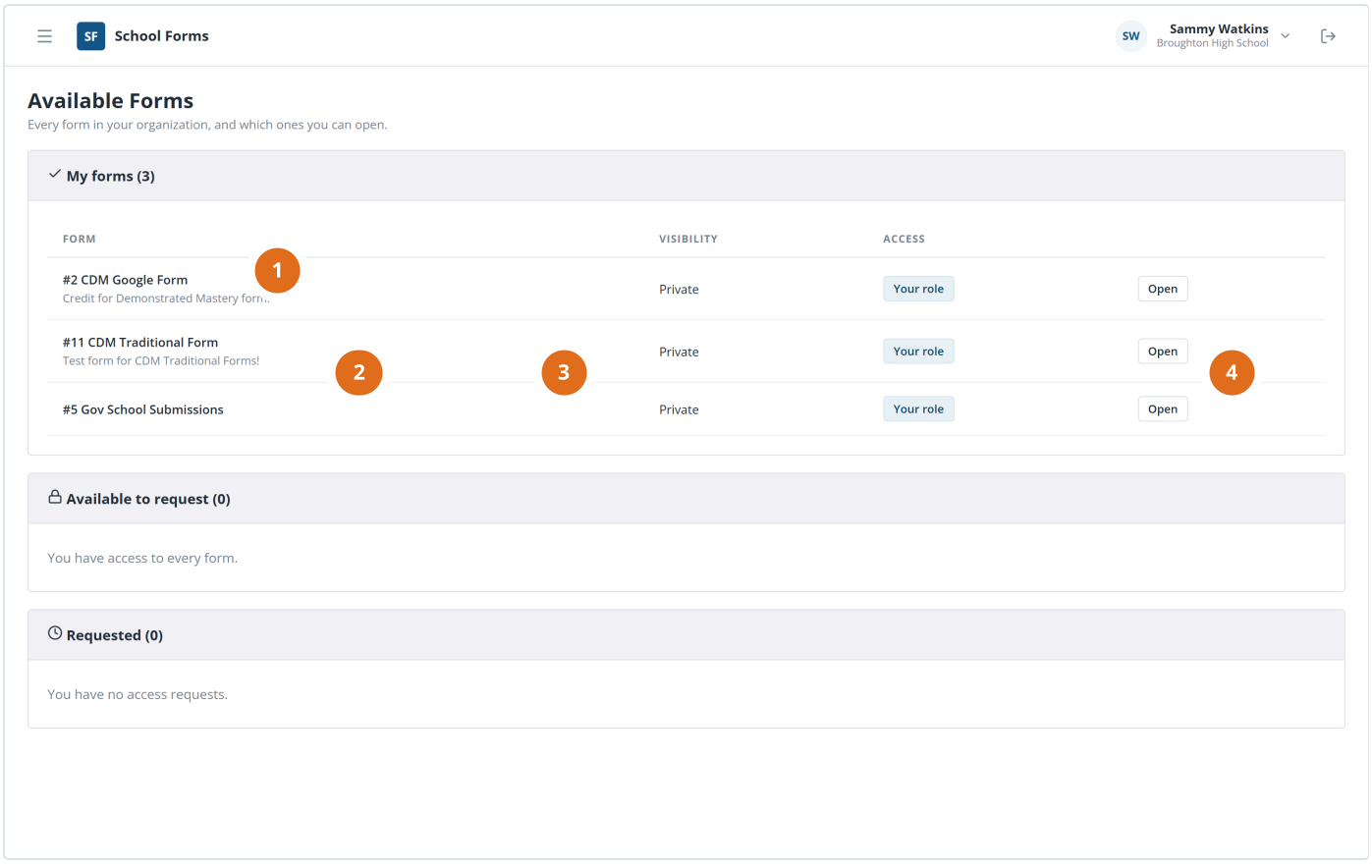



**Figure 3 — Available Forms.**

1. **My forms** — the forms you can open right now.
2. The form's number and title. The number is the one an administrator refers to.
3. **Access** — why you have it: *Public*, *Your role*, or *Granted*.
4. **Open** — jumps straight to your queue, filtered to that form.

The page has three sections:

| SECTION | WHAT IT MEANS |
|---|---|
| **My forms** | You can open these now. |
| **Available to request** | A private form you do not hold. You can ask an administrator for it. |
| **Requested** | You asked, and nobody has answered yet. |

## 2.2 Requesting access to a private form

1. Open **Available Forms**.
2. Find the form under **Available to request**.
3. Click **Request access**.
4. The row moves to **Requested** and shows **Waiting since …**.

An administrator is notified in the app. You do not need to send an email as well.

> **If your request was declined**
>
> The form returns to **Available to request** with the word *Declined* and, usually, the administrator's reason. You may ask again — **Request access** works the same way the second time.

# 2.3 Tracking and withdrawing a request

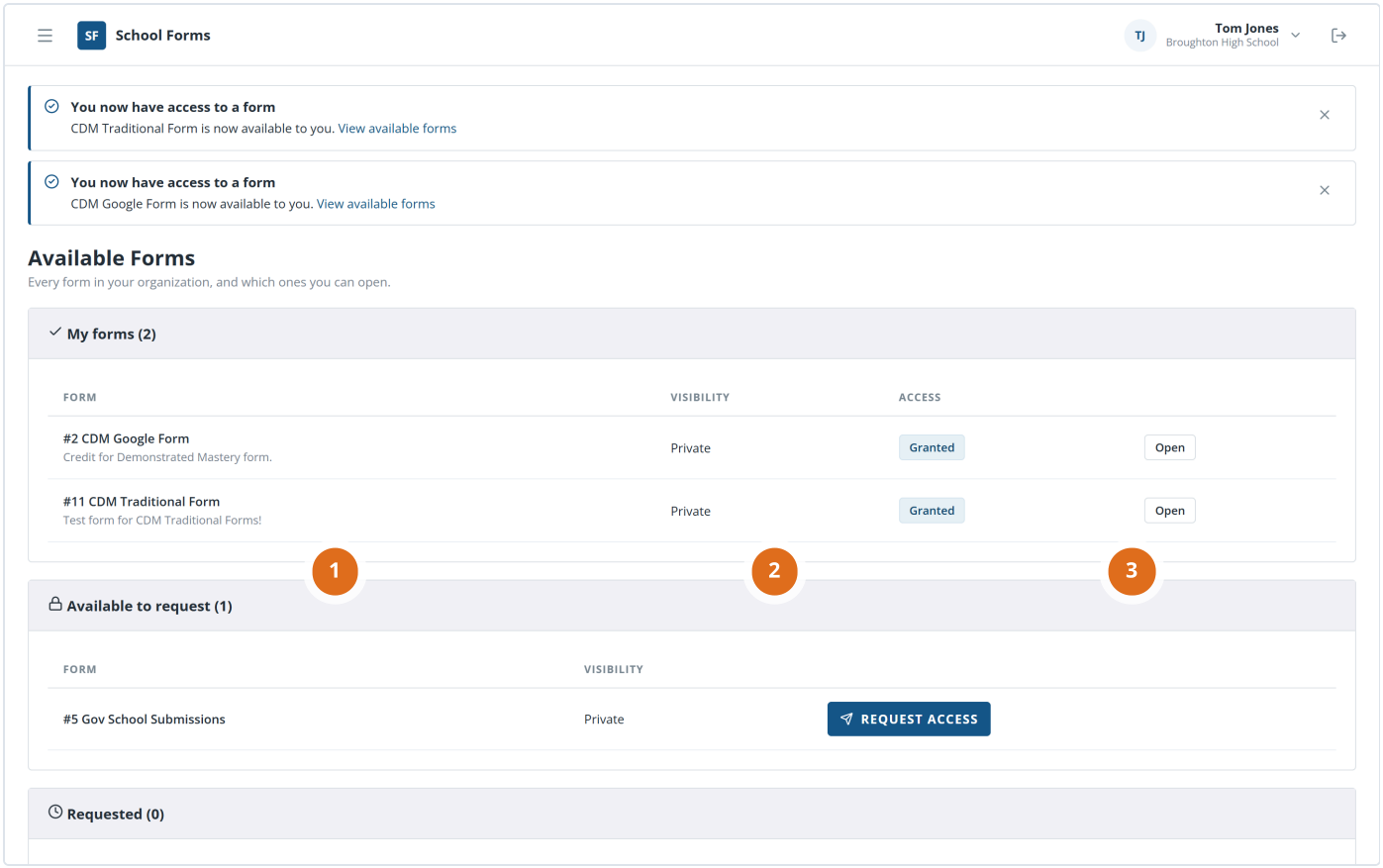



**Figure 4 — A request that is waiting.**

1. The form you asked for.
2. **Waiting since …** — when you asked.
3. **Withdraw** — cancels the request. The form goes back to **Available to request**.

> **Tip**
>
> If you open a form you do not hold — for example from a link a colleague sent you — the queue shows a locked panel explaining that the form is private, with the same **Request access** button.

# 3. Your submissions queue

The queue is where you spend most of your time. It is also where you can fill in staff-only fields without opening a submission at all — see Part 4.

## 3.1 The queue at a glance

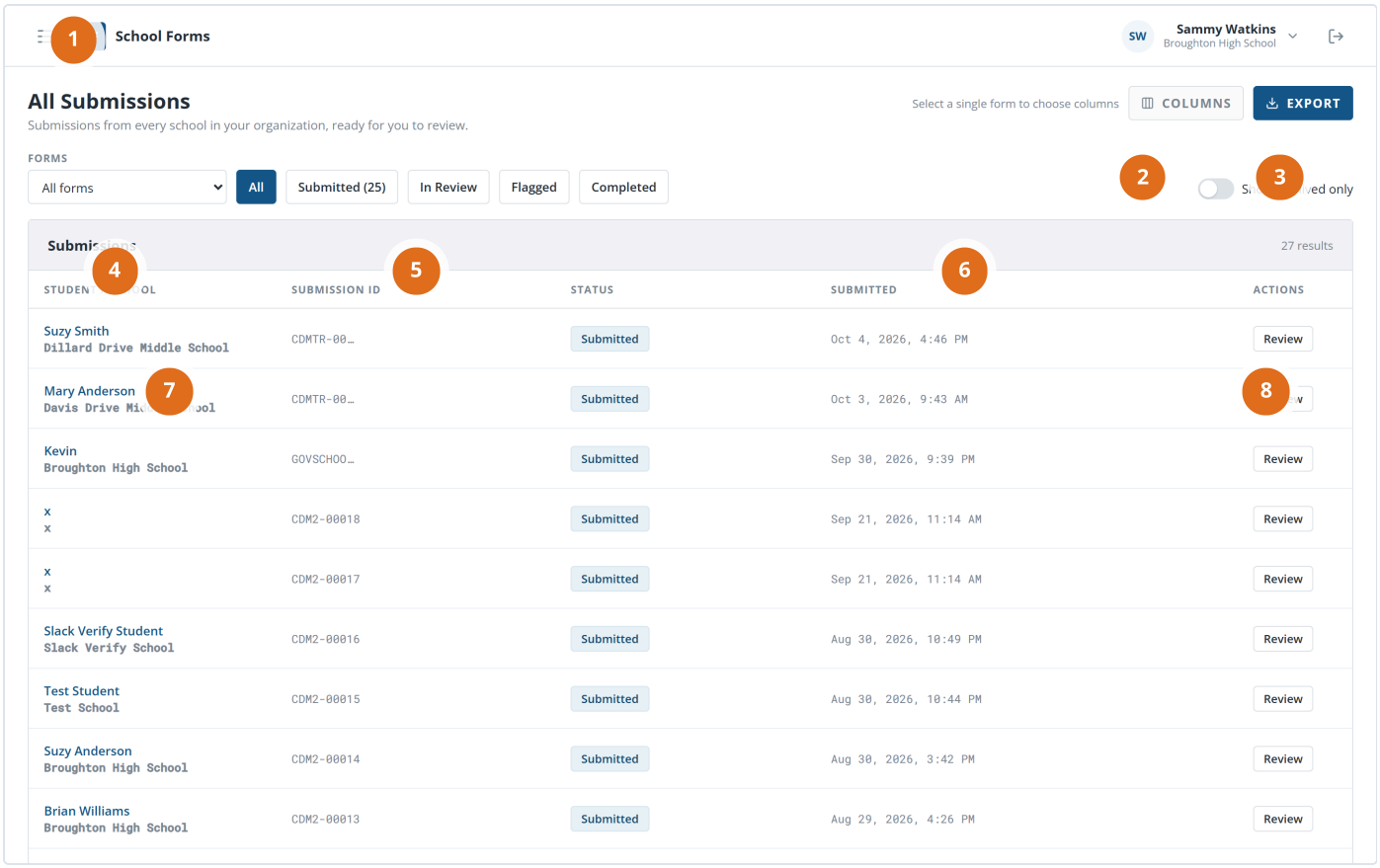



**Figure 5 — The queue.**

1. The page title. A School Contact sees their school's name here instead.
2. **Columns** — choose which fields appear.
3. **Export** — download what you see as a spreadsheet.
4. **Forms** — narrow the queue to one form.
5. Status chips — **All**, **Submitted**, **In Review**, **Flagged**, **Completed**.
6. **Show archived only** — look at put-away submissions instead of live ones.
7. A row. The student's name opens the submission; the school sits underneath.
8. **Review** — opens the same submission as the name.

> **Table and card views**
>
> There is no table/card switch. The grid is a table on a desktop screen and stacks into cards on a narrow one, automatically. Inline editing is only available in the table layout.

## 3.2 Filtering by status

Click a status chip to show only submissions in that state. The **Submitted** chip carries a count so you can see at a glance how much is waiting.

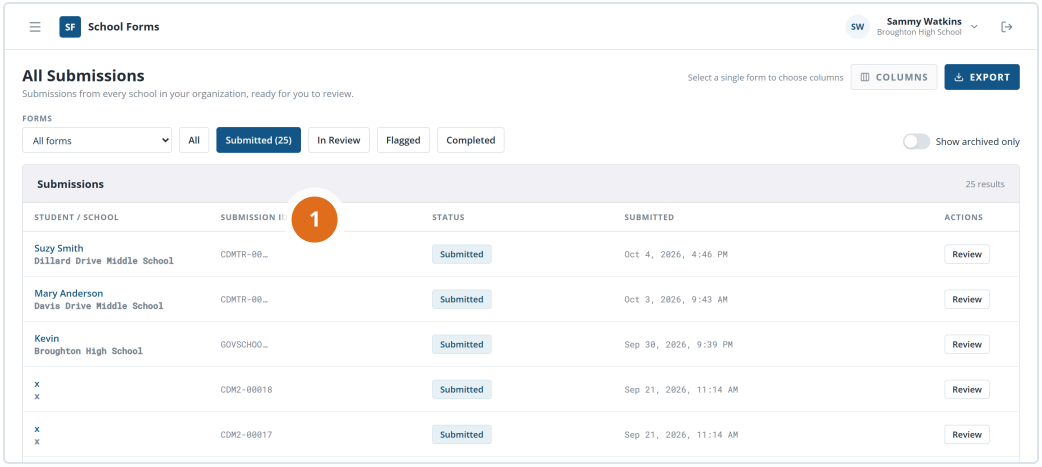



**Figure 6 — A status chip is selected.**

1. The selected chip is filled in. Click **All** to clear the filter.

## 3.3 Filtering by form

When more than one form is open to you, the **Forms** dropdown appears. Choosing a form narrows the queue and adds that form's fields as columns.

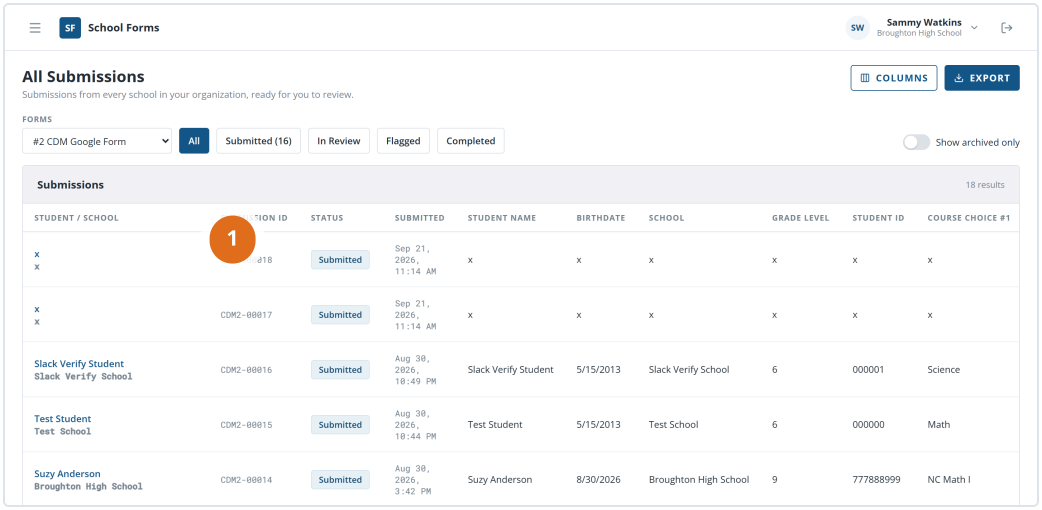



**Figure 7 — Scoped to one form.**

1. The form is selected. **All forms** goes back to the combined queue.

> **Tip**
>
> If only one form is open to you, the queue selects it for you and the dropdown is not shown — there is no choice to make.

# 3.4 Choosing columns

Click **Columns** to choose which fields appear in the grid.

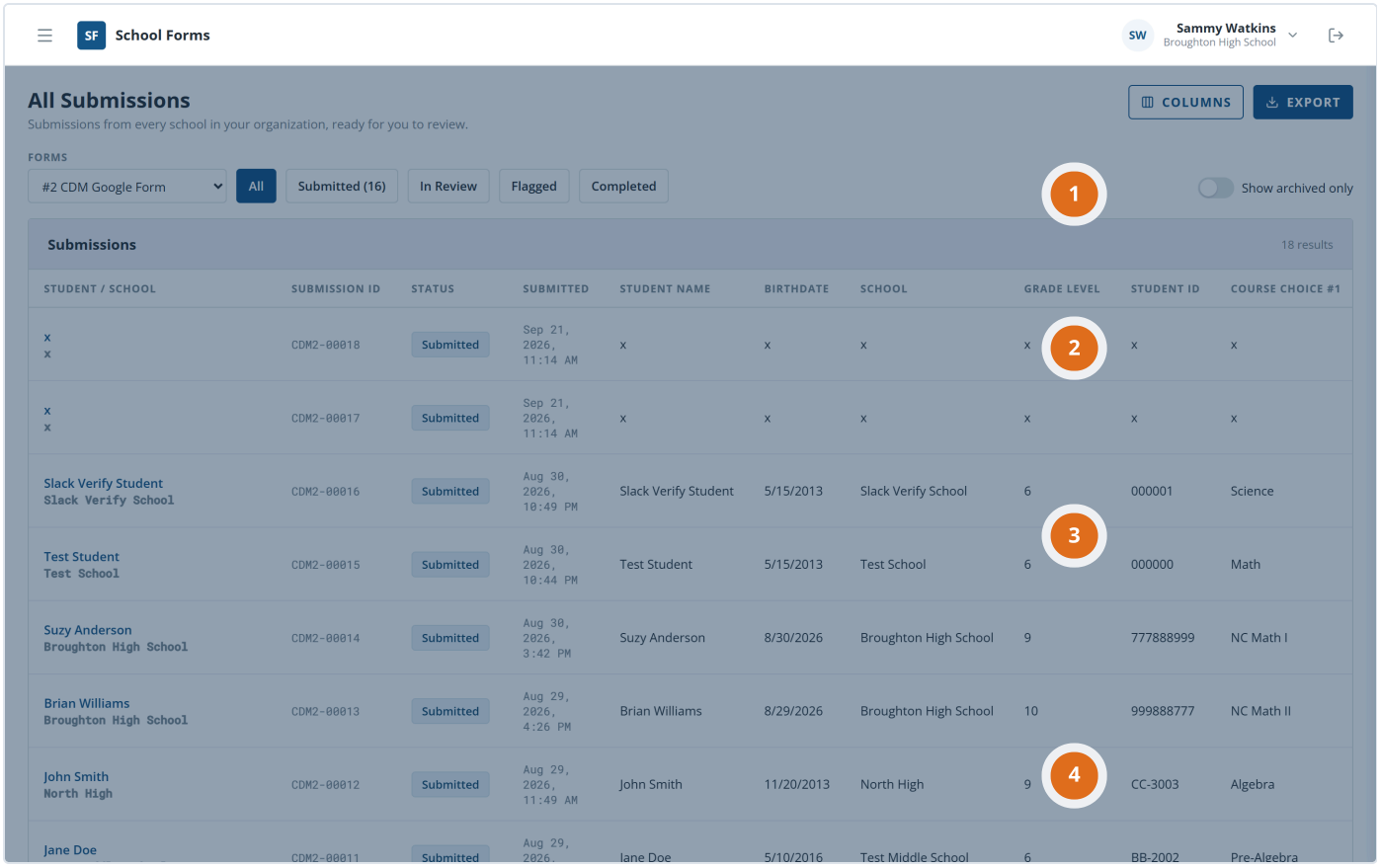



**Figure 8 — The column drawer.**

1. **Select all**, with a running count of what is ticked.
2. **Student / School** is always shown and cannot be turned off — it is the column that stays put when you scroll sideways.
3. Fields marked **Staff** are staff-only fields. They always sort to the end of the grid.
4. **Done** closes the drawer. Your choice is remembered for you, per form.

## 3.5 Showing archived submissions

Archiving puts a submission away without deleting it. Switch on **Show archived only** to list the archived ones instead of the live ones.

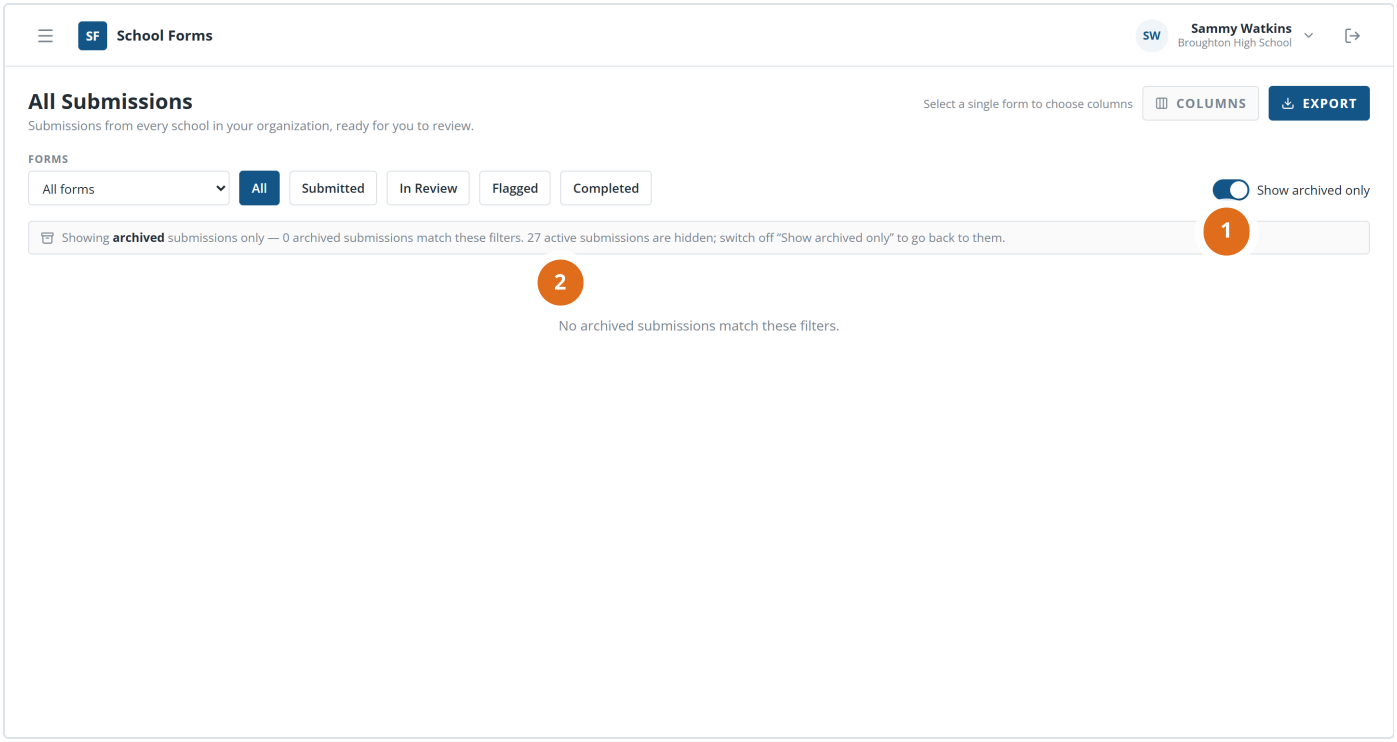



**Figure 9 — The archived view.**

1. The switch is on.
2. The strip tells you what the filter is hiding and how to get back to it.

> **Where archived submissions disappear from**
>
> An archived submission is hidden from the queue, exports, reports, the documents list and the sign-in summary. It is *not* deleted: you can still open it from a bookmark, and you can restore it. See 5.4 Archiving and restoring.

# 4. Filling in staff-only fields

Staff-only fields are the internal half of a form: questions an administrator added for you, which parents never see. You can fill them in two ways — quickly, in the queue, or in full on the submission page.

## 4.1 What staff-only fields are

In the designer, a form has two lists of fields: **Form Fields**, which parents answer, and **Staff Only Fields**, which they never see. Every staff-only field also carries an **Access** setting, so a field can be visible to Staff but not to School Contacts, or to Administrators only.

In the queue, staff-only columns are tinted and sorted to the end, after the parent's answers.

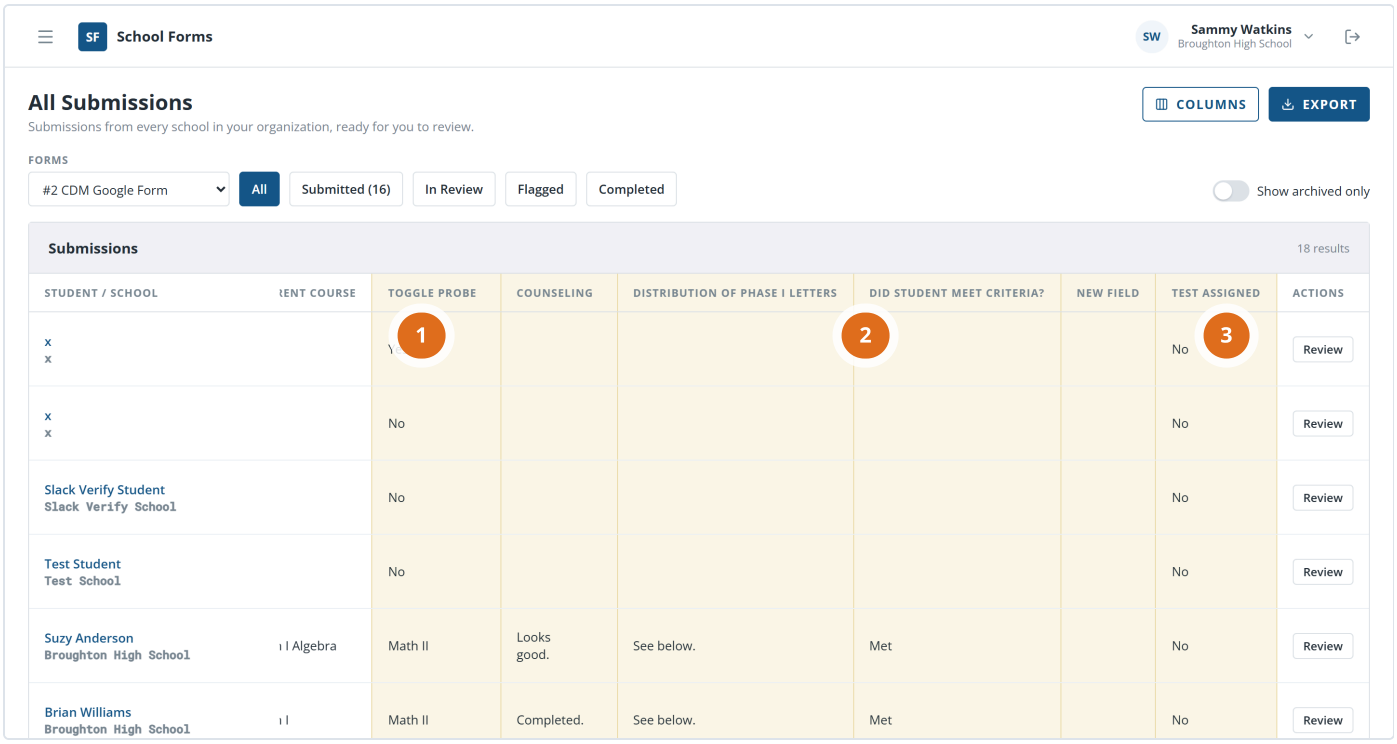



**Figure 10 — Staff-only columns in the queue.**

1. A staff-only column. The tint is the only marker — there is no badge in the header.
2. An empty staff-only cell. Hovering shows a small pencil, meaning *click to edit*.
3. The last columns are always the staff-only ones, then **Actions**.

## 4.2 Filling in a field inline from the queue

This is the fastest way to fill in one or two fields for several students in a row. The value is saved to the submission the moment you finish editing the cell.

1. Open the queue and, if you have more than one form, pick the form in **Forms**.
2. Make sure the column you need is ticked in **Columns**. Staff-only fields sort to the right-hand end; scroll sideways to reach them.
3. Click the cell. It turns into an editor with the caret already in it.
4. Type or choose the value.
5. Press **Enter**, or click another cell. The cell briefly shows it has saved.

## Text, Text Area, Number, Date and Email

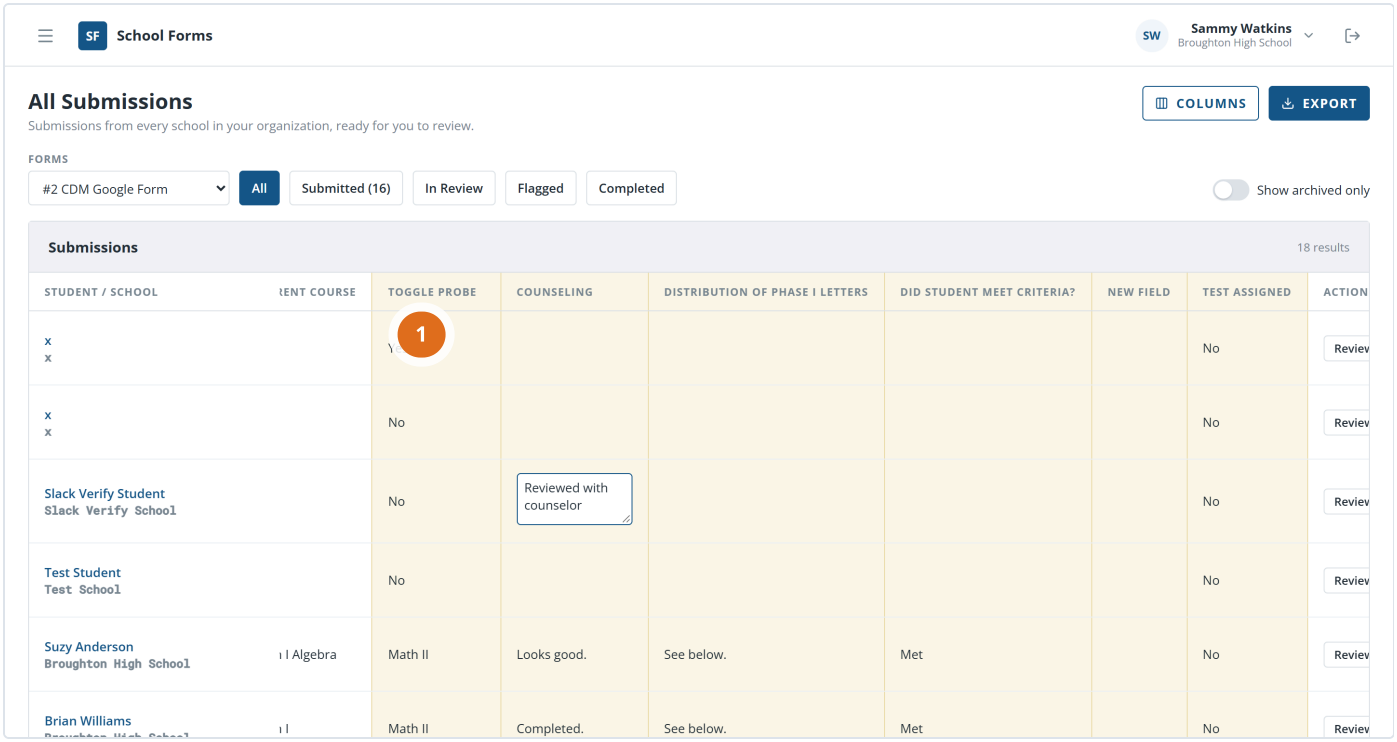



**Figure 11 — Editing a text field inline.**

1. The cell is an editor. Long answers use a text area, where **Shift+Enter** starts a new line and **Enter** alone saves.

## Toggle (Yes / No)

A Toggle field is a switch with exactly two answers. Flipping it saves immediately — there is no separate confirm step.

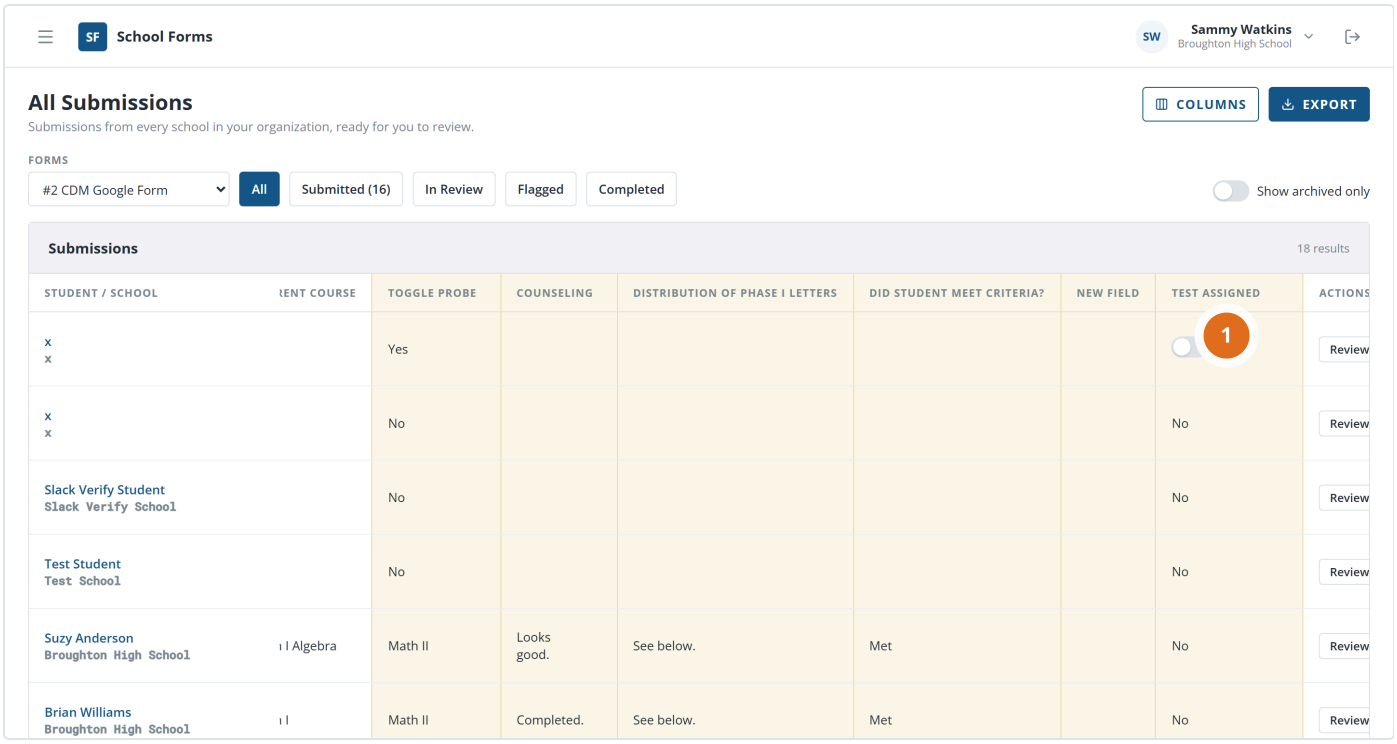



**Figure 12 — A toggle inside a cell.**

1. Click the switch to turn it on or off. The label beside it reads **Yes** or **No**, and that word is what is stored and exported.

## Select, Radio and Checkbox

Cells that offer a list of choices open a small menu instead of a text box.

- **Select** and a single-option **Checkbox** save as soon as you pick a value.
- **Radio** and a multi-option **Checkbox** open a menu with **Save** and **Cancel**.

## Keyboard and save rules

| KEY OR ACTION | WHAT HAPPENS |
|---|---|
| **Enter** | Saves the cell. |
| **Shift+Enter** | New line inside a text area (does not save). |
| **Esc** | Discards your edit and restores the previous value. |
| Clicking another cell | Saves the cell you were editing, then opens the new one. |

> **Only staff-only cells can be edited here**
>
> A parent's answers are shown in the queue but cannot be changed in it. To correct one, open the submission and use **Edit** — see 5.3.

## 4.3 Filling in staff-only fields from submission details

Use this when you are reviewing a submission properly, or when a field needs a longer answer than fits in a cell.

1. Click the student's name, or **Review**, on a row.
2. Scroll down to the **Staff-only fields** card.
3. Fill in each field. These boxes are always editable — there is no **Edit** step for them.
4. Click **Save staff fields**.

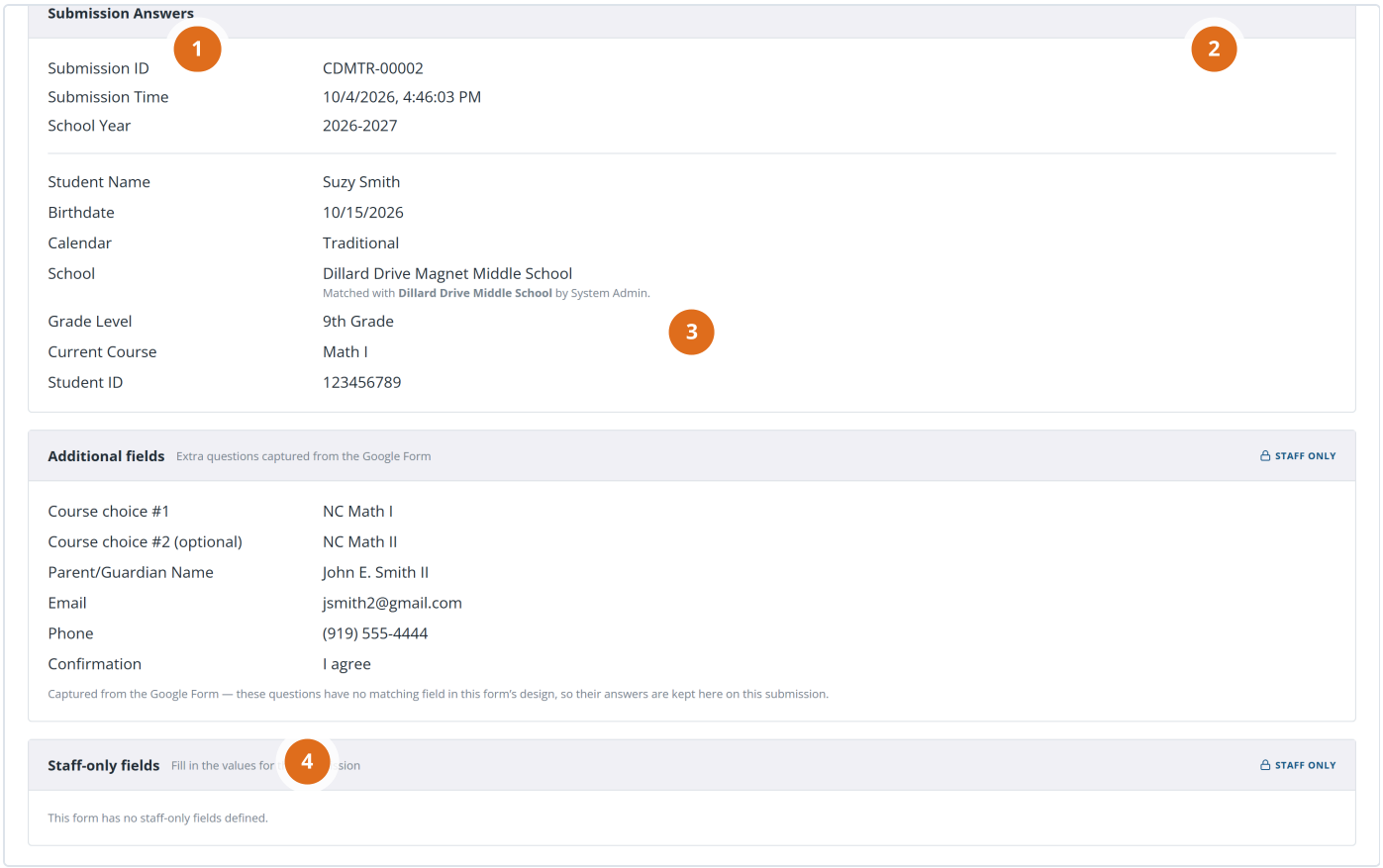



**Figure 13 — The Staff-only fields card.**

1. The card heading.
2. The **Staff only** lock tag — a reminder that parents never see these values.
3. One box per staff-only field, in the order the administrator arranged them.
4. **Save staff fields** — saves every field on the card at once.

**What gets recorded**

After you save, a line under the button records who last saved these fields and when — for example *Last saved by Sammy Watkins on 10/25/2026, 2:14 PM*. It is there so a colleague can see whose answer they are looking at.

**If the form has no staff-only fields**

The card says *This form has no staff-only fields defined.* That is a decision the administrator made in the designer, not a fault.

## 4.4 Which method should I use?

| YOU WANT TO… | USE |
|---|---|
| Fill in one field for many students | **Inline in the queue** — the field stays put and you move down the column. |
| Write a long note | **Submission details** — the boxes there are taller and have an Expand button. |
| Review a submission properly, then record your decision | **Submission details** — you can also change the status on the same page. |
| Change a parent's answer | **Submission details** — the queue is read-only for parent fields. |

Both methods write to the same submission, so you can use either one at any time.

# 5. Reviewing a submission

## 5.1 The submission detail page

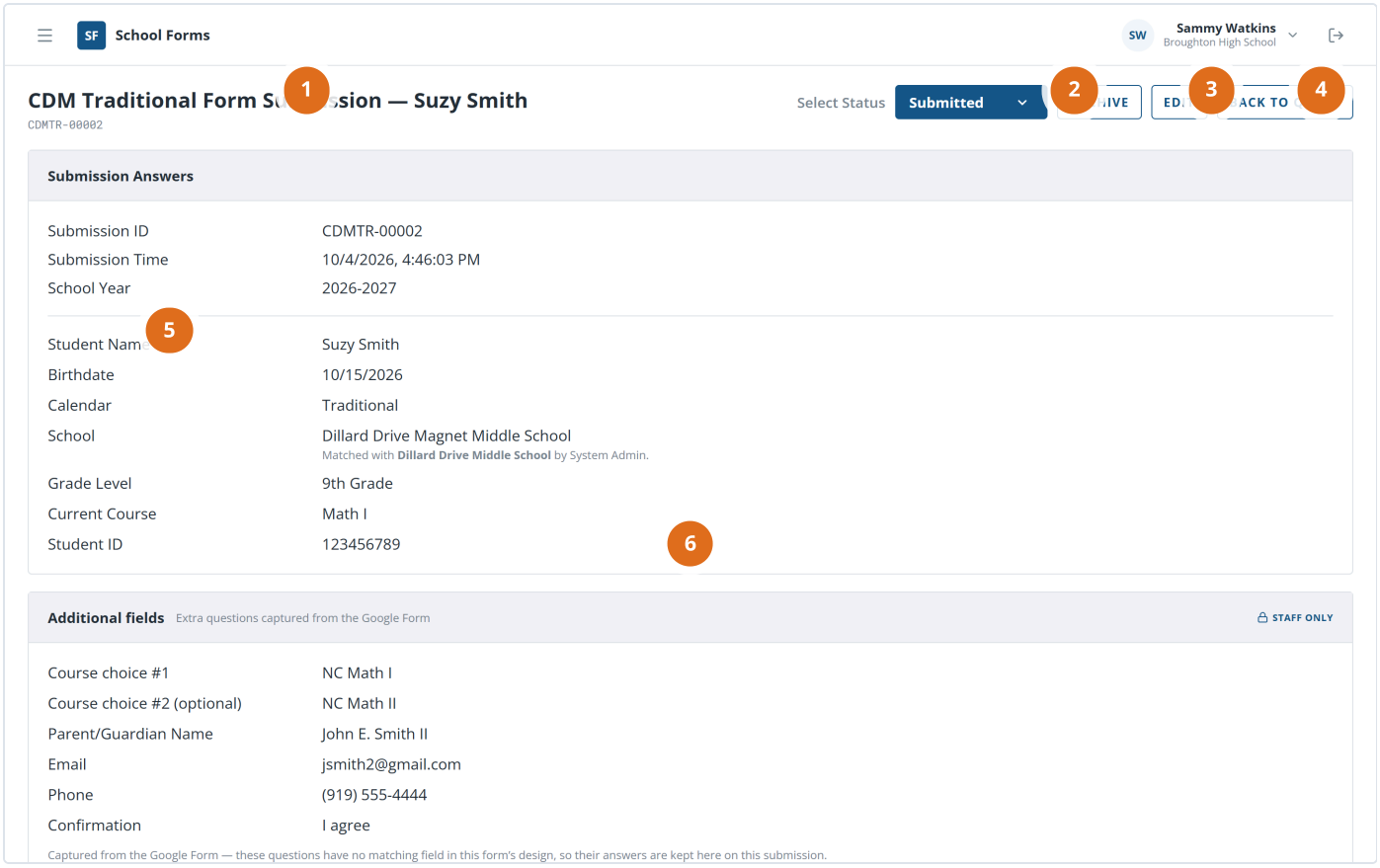



**Figure 14 — A submission.**

1. The form name, the student and the submission ID.
2. **Select Status** — see 5.2.
3. **Archive** and **Edit** — see 5.3 and 5.4.
4. **Back to queue**.
5. **Submission Answers** — the submission ID, when it arrived, the school year, then the parent's answers.
6. Where the **Staff-only fields** card begins, further down the page.

> **About the submission ID**
>
> The ID is what you quote when you need to talk about a submission with a parent or a colleague. It is also the last part of the page's address, so a bookmark keeps working.

## 5.2 Changing the status

Use **Select Status** in the page header. The change saves as soon as you pick a value — there is nothing to confirm.

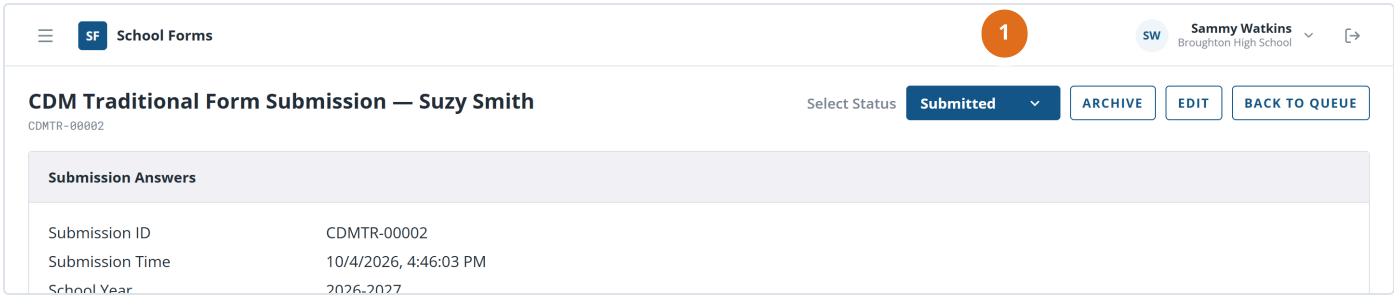



**Figure 15 — The status control.**

1. **Select Status** — choose **Submitted**, **In Review**, **Flagged** or **Completed**. See 9.1 for what each one means.

## 5.3 Editing a parent's answers

1. Click **Edit** in the page header.
2. The answers become editable, and **Cancel** and **Save changes** appear above them.
3. Change what you need.
4. Click **Save changes**. **Cancel** throws your edits away.

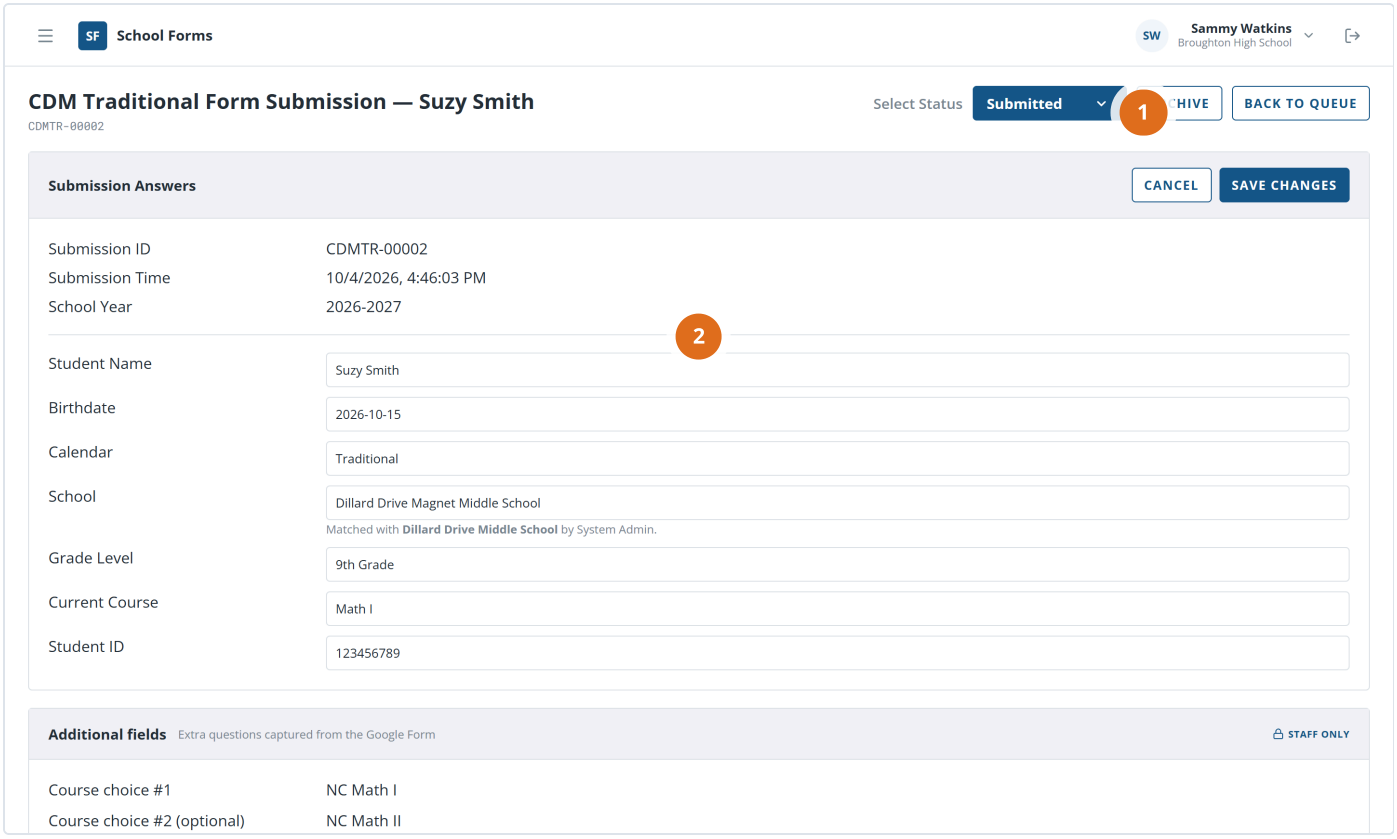



**Figure 16 — Edit mode.**

1. **Cancel** and **Save changes**.
2. Each answer is now a box. Nothing is saved until you click **Save changes**.

> **Edit changes the parent's answer**
>
> Use this to correct a typo or a misread entry. The parent is not notified, and the original wording is not kept — so if the answer is in doubt, record the reason in a staff-only field before you change it.

## 5.4 Archiving and restoring

**Archive** in the page header puts a submission away. It disappears from the queue, exports, reports and the documents list, but nothing is deleted.

1. Open the submission.
2. Click **Archive**.
3. To bring it back, open it again — from a bookmark, or from the queue with **Show archived only** switched on — and click **Restore**.

An archived submission shows a notice at the top of the page explaining that it is hidden and who archived it, and when.

**Deleting is not available to you**

Permanent deletion is an administrator action and is never offered on a staff account. Archiving is the reversible option, and it is the right one when you are unsure.

# 6. Documents

> **Documents may not be switched on for you**
>
> The **Documents** menu item and the document line on a submission appear only when an administrator has enabled them for your role. If you do not see them, the feature is off — not broken.

## 6.1 The Generated Documents list

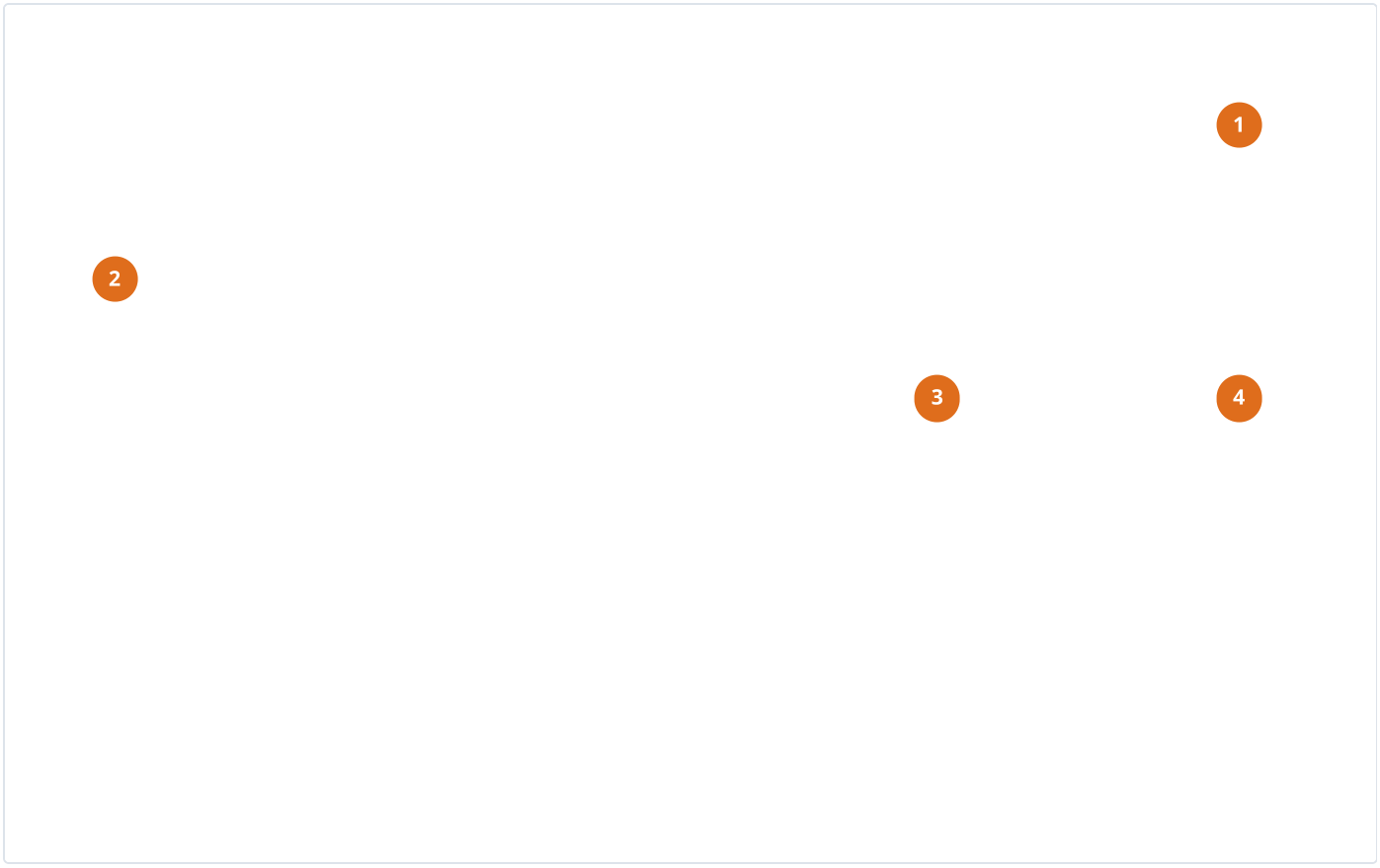



**Figure 17 — Generated documents.**

1. **Refresh** — reloads the list, useful while a document is still being made.
2. The columns: date, student, school, course title, Phase I result, document and status.
3. **Open** opens the Google Doc; **View PDF** previews it here.
4. The document's status — **Pending**, **Completed** or **Failed**.

## 6.2 Opening a document

Click **View PDF** to preview a document without leaving the app. A panel slides in from the right with the document's details and the page preview.

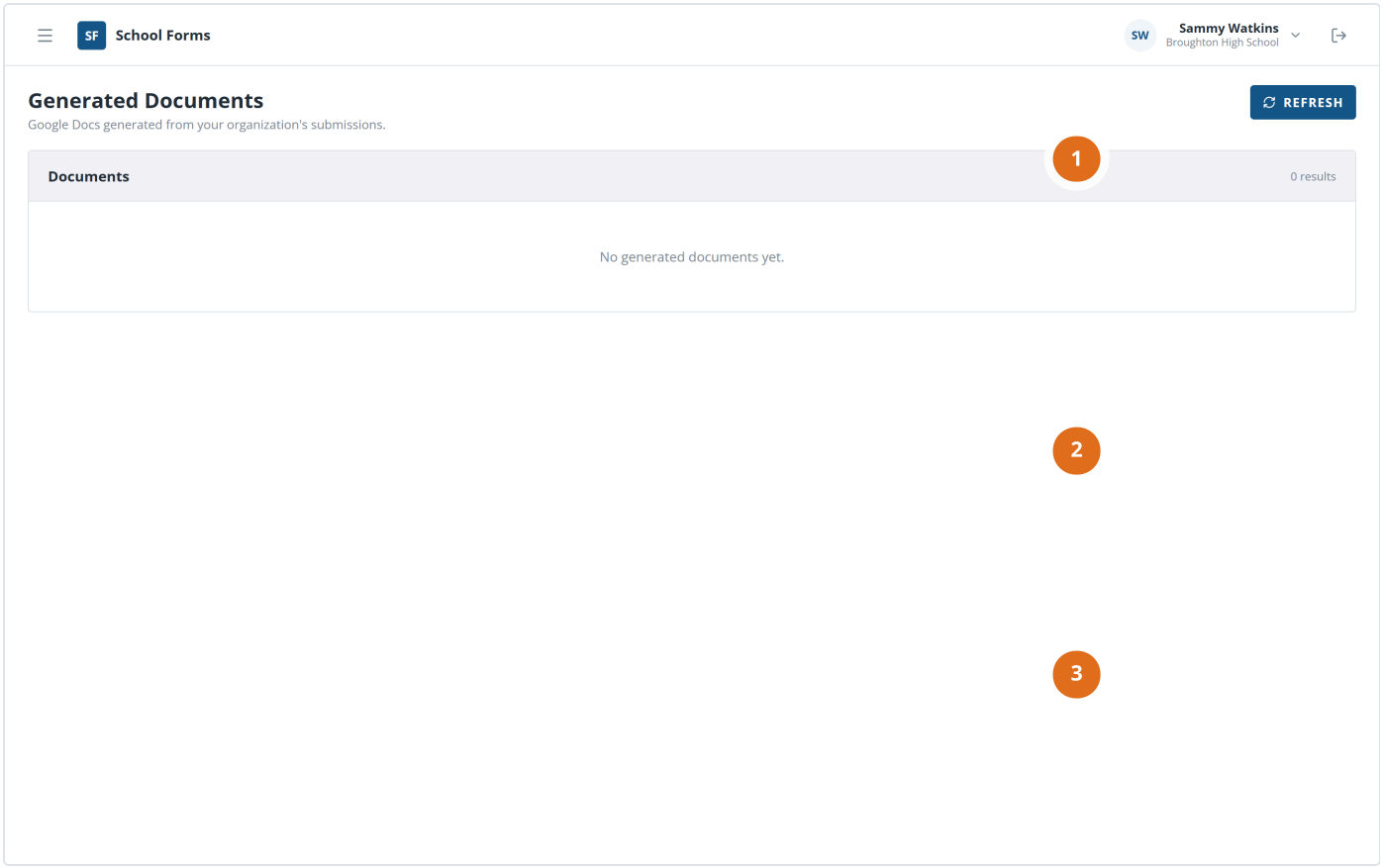



**Figure 18 — The document preview.**

1. **Document Details** — the submission this came from and its values.
2. **Open in Google Docs** — opens the file itself, where you can print or share it.
3. **Preview** — the rendered page.

> **If a document says Failed**
>
> Open the submission it belongs to. A **Retry** button appears beside the failed document, and a document that is still being made shows a spinner instead.

> **Opening the Google Doc needs Drive permission**
>
> School Forms builds the link but does not grant access to the file. If Google says you do not have permission, ask a colleague to share the document or the folder it lives in.

# 7. Reports and export

Reports builds a filtered table from one form's submissions and exports exactly what is on screen — as CSV, Excel or PDF.

## 7.1 Building a report

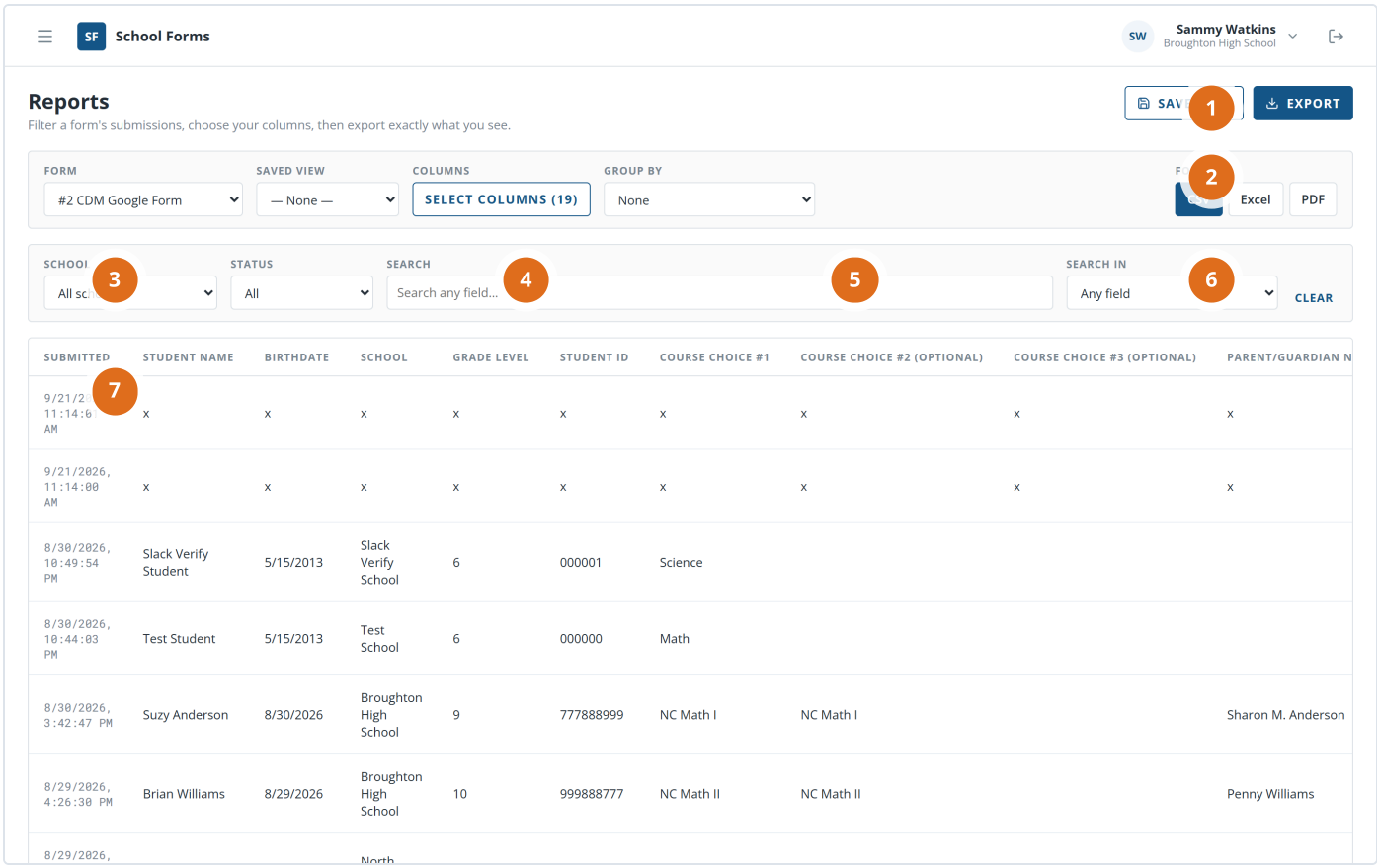



**Figure 19 — The Reports page.**

1. **Save View** — keeps the current filters and columns under a name.
2. **Export** — downloads the report in the chosen format.
3. **Form** — required. The available columns belong to the form you pick.
4. **Saved View** — apply a view you saved earlier.
5. **Select Columns** — see 7.2.
6. **Group by** and **Format** — see 7.3.
7. **Status** and **Search**. A School Contact has no **School** filter here — their school is fixed.

1. Pick a **Form**.
2. Narrow the rows with **Status** and **Search**. The search box looks across every answer on a row; **Search in** narrows the same word to one column.

3. Choose your columns (7.2) and, if you like, a **Group by** (7.3).
4. Pick a **Format**: **CSV**, **Excel** or **PDF**.
5. Click **Export**.

> **What you see is what you get**
>
> The preview grid and the exported file are built from the same query, so the file always matches the screen. If the preview looks wrong, change the filters before exporting.

## 7.2 Selecting columns

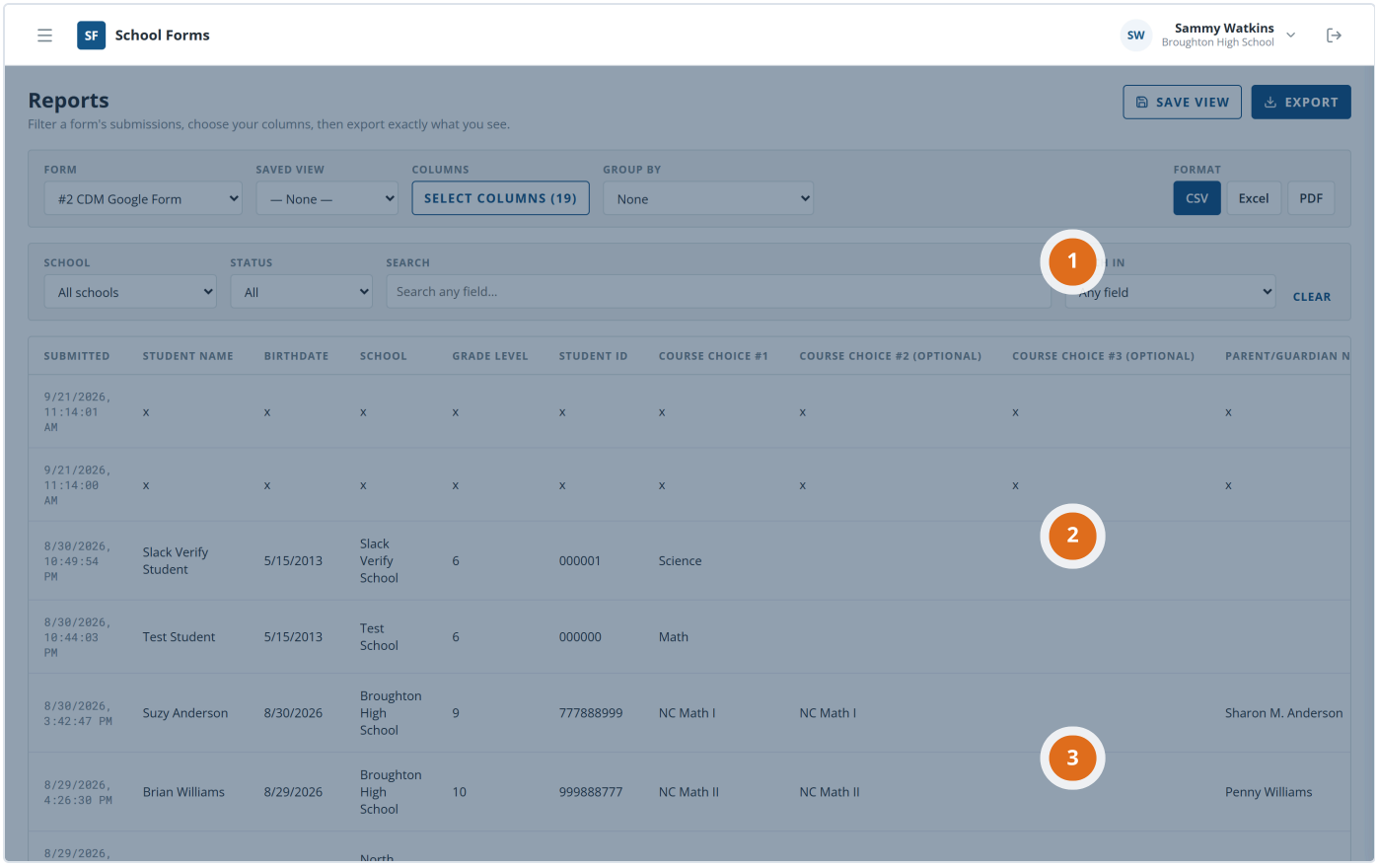



**Figure 20 — Choosing report columns.**

1. Tick the fields to show in the preview and include in the export.
2. Staff-only fields are in the same list, so a report can include them.
3. The footer counts your selection. **Done** closes the drawer.

> **Tip**
>
> If you untick every column, the report falls back to every column you have access to rather than showing nothing — so a report is never empty by accident.

## 7.3 Grouping rows

Choose a **Group by** column to break the report into sections with a row count each. Click a group heading to collapse or expand it.

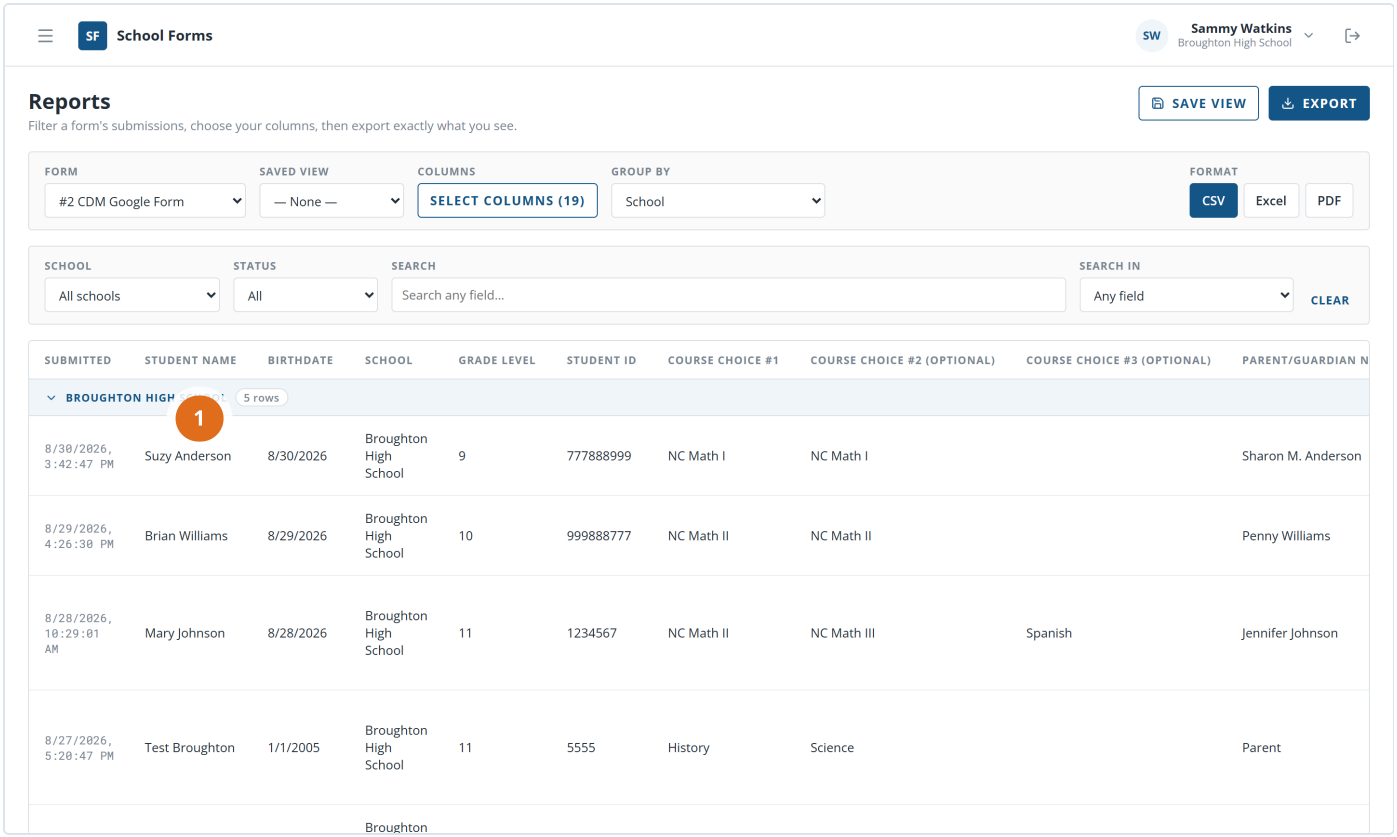



**Figure 21 — Grouped by school.**

1. A group heading with its row count. Click it to collapse the group.

## 7.4 Saving a view

1. Set up the form, filters, columns and format you want.
2. Click **Save View**.
3. Give it a name and click **Save as New**.
4. Next time, pick it from **Saved View**.

Saved views are private to your account. To change one, apply it, adjust the report, then click **Update View**. **Make Default** marks it as the one you want first, and **Delete** removes it.

## 7.5 Exporting from the queue

The queue has its own quick export, which is CSV only.

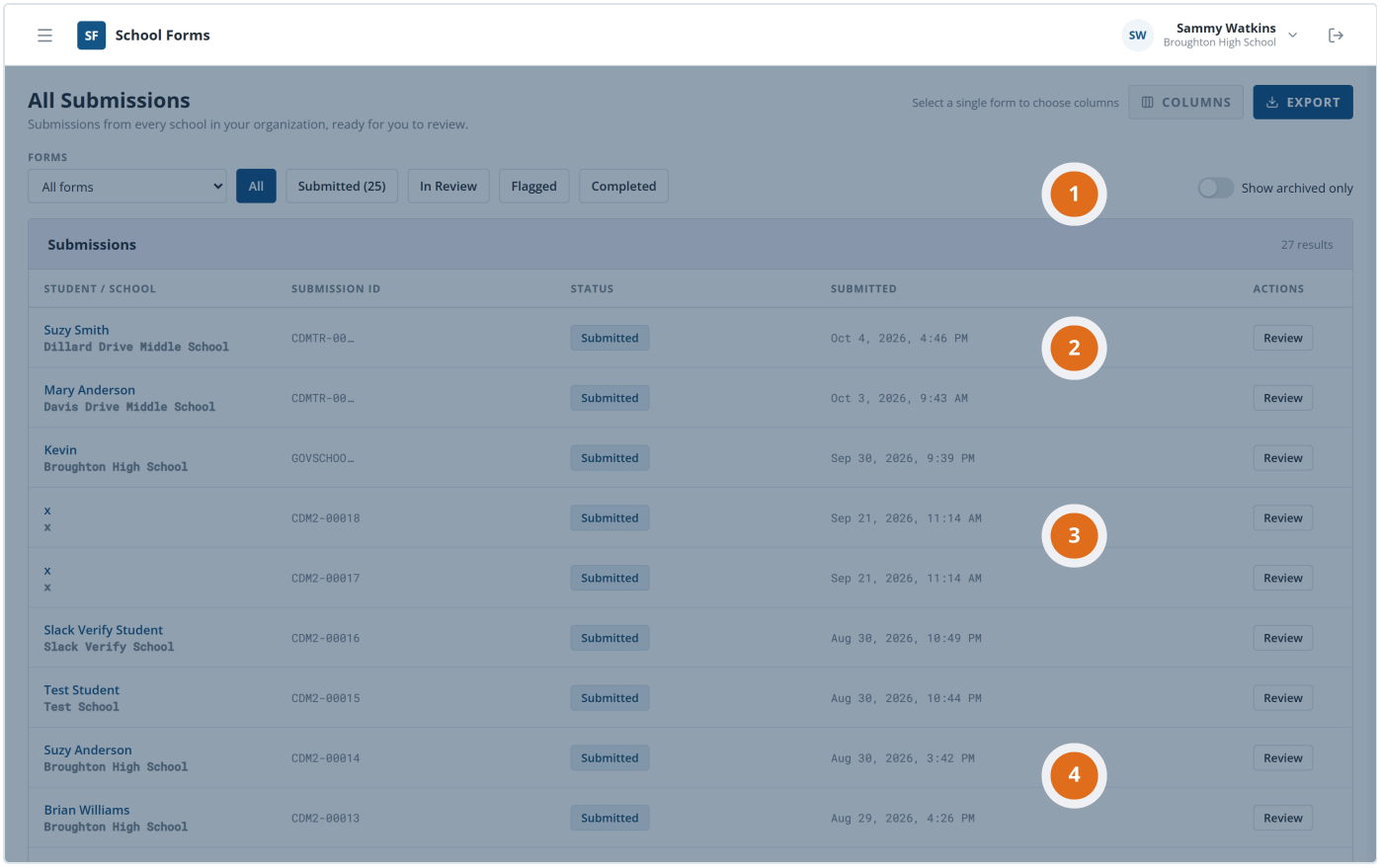



**Figure 22 — Exporting from the queue.**

1. How many rows and columns the file will contain.
2. Tick the columns to export.
3. A preview of the first rows.
4. **Export CSV** downloads the file.

The file downloads as `submissions-export.csv`. Use Reports instead when you need Excel or PDF, or when you want to save the setup for next time.

# 8. Your account

## 8.1 Changing your password

1. Click your name in the top-right corner of the banner.
2. Choose **Change password**.
3. Type your **Current Password**, then your **New Password** twice.
4. Click **Update password**.

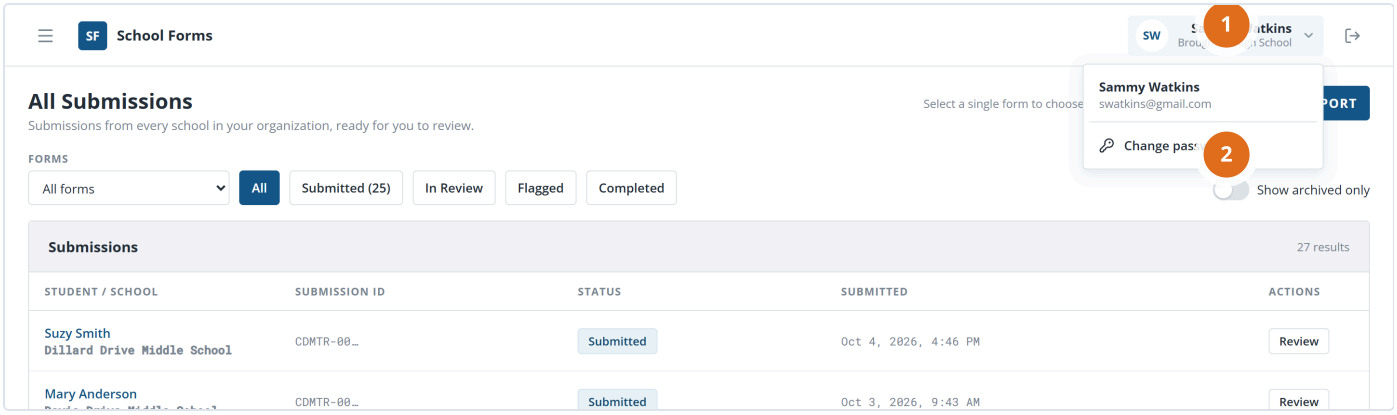



**Figure 23 — The account menu.**

1. Your name, school and avatar. Click to open the menu.
2. **Change password**.

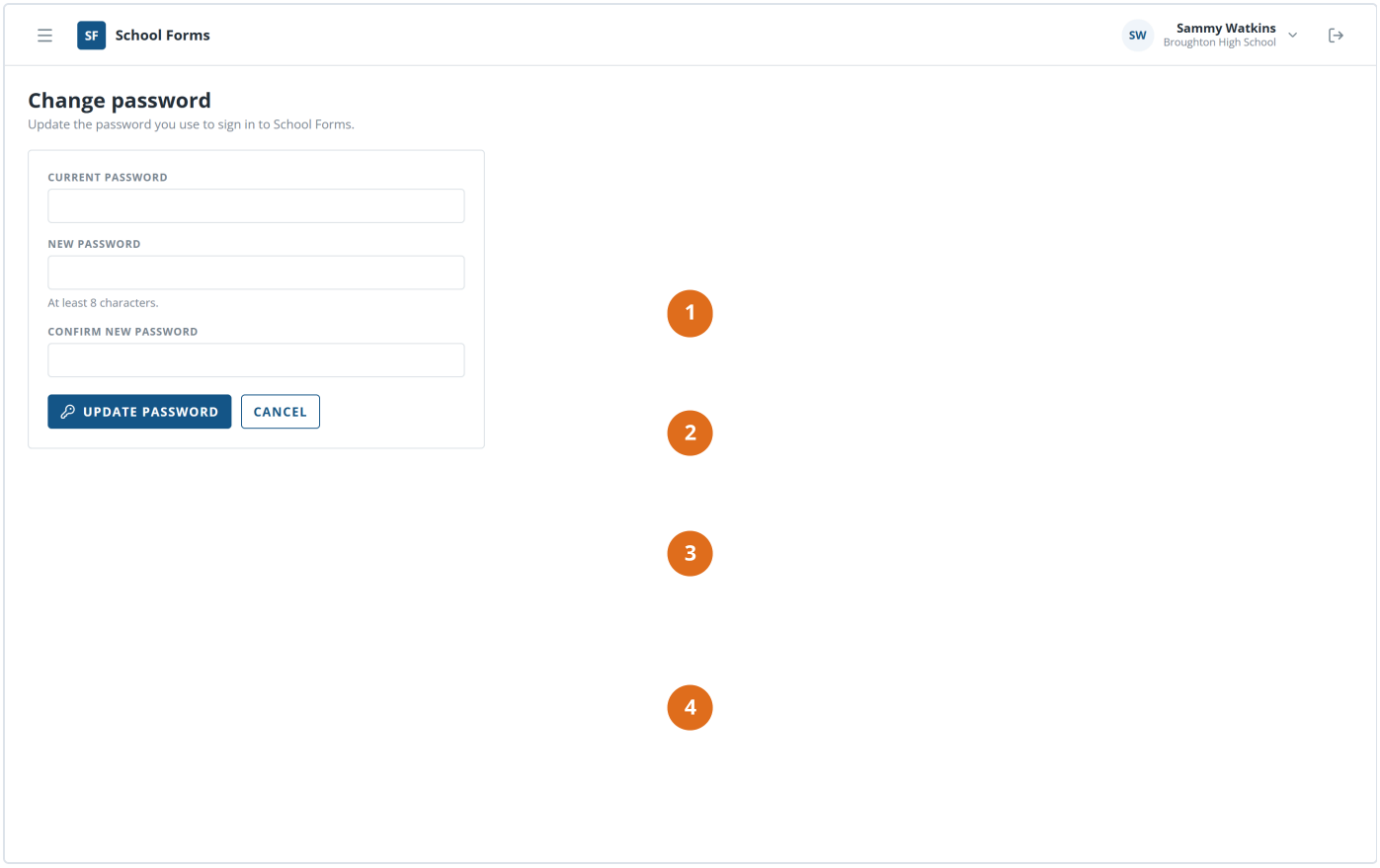



**Figure 24 — The password form.**

1. **Current Password** — you must prove you know it, even though you are signed in.
2. **New Password** — at least 8 characters.
3. **Confirm New Password** — must match.
4. **Update password**. **Cancel** returns to your work.

> **Other sessions stay signed in**
>
> Changing your password does not sign out copies of School Forms that are already open elsewhere. If you think someone else is using your account, change the password and tell an administrator.

> **If an administrator gave you a temporary password**
>
> You are taken straight to a version of this page that asks for your **Temporary Password** instead. It has no **Cancel** — only **Sign out** — because the rest of the app stays locked until the password is changed.

## 8.2 Signing out

Click the log-out button at the far right of the banner. It is the icon beside your name, and it signs you out immediately without asking for confirmation.

# 9. Reference

## 9.1 Status meanings

| STATUS | MEANING |
|---|---|
| **Submitted** | Received and waiting for review. |
| **In Review** | Someone is working on it. |
| **Flagged** | Needs attention or a follow-up. |
| **Completed** | Reviewed and finished. |

Document statuses are separate:

| DOCUMENT STATUS | MEANING |
|---|---|
| **Pending** | Still being generated. |
| **Completed** | Ready to open or preview. |
| **Failed** | Generation failed. Open the submission and click **Retry**. |

## 9.2 Field types

| TYPE | WHAT IT LOOKS LIKE | HOW IT SAVES INLINE |
|---|---|---|
| **Text** | A short single-line answer. | Enter or click away. |
| **Text Area** | A longer answer with line breaks. | Enter saves; Shift+Enter adds a line. |
| **Number** | A numeric value. | Enter or click away. |
| **Date** | A calendar date. | Enter or click away. |
| **Email** | An email address. | Enter or click away. |
| **Select** | A dropdown of options. | As soon as you pick one. |
| **Radio** | One choice from a short list. | From the option menu, with **Save**. |
| **Checkbox** | One or more choices. | From the option menu, with **Save**. |
| **Toggle** | A switch reading **No** or **Yes**. | As soon as you flip it. |
| **Google Document** | A link to a file in Google Drive. | Not editable inline. |

## 9.3 "I can't see it"

| WHAT IS MISSING | LIKELY REASON |
|---|---|
| **Available Forms** or **Reports** in the menu | An administrator hid it in **Settings** → **Menu Settings**. Ask them to check. |
| **Documents** in the menu, or the document line on a submission | The Documents feature is switched off for your role. |
| A private form | You do not hold access yet. Open **Available Forms** and request it. |
| A staff-only field | Its **Access** setting in the designer does not include your role. |
| The **Forms** dropdown on the queue | Only one form is open to you, so the queue selected it for you. |
| The **School** filter | You are a School Contact — your school is fixed. |
| A submission you saw yesterday | It may have been archived. Switch on **Show archived only** in the queue. |

## 9.4 Troubleshooting

| SYMPTOM | WHAT TO DO |
|---|---|
| The queue says submissions could not be loaded | That is a failed request, not an empty queue. Click **Try again**; if it persists, tell an administrator. |
| A cell will not save | A red message appears under the cell. Check the value — a number field will not accept letters, and a date needs a real date. Press **Esc** to abandon the edit. |
| A form says it is not accepting submissions | The form is not published. Only an administrator can publish it. |
| A Google Doc link says you do not have access | Drive permissions are separate from School Forms. Ask for the file or its folder to be shared with you. |
| You are stuck on the temporary-password page | Set a new password, or click **Sign out** and ask an administrator for help. |

**Still stuck?**

Note the **Submission ID** (or the form's number) and the time it happened, and contact your administrator. Those two details let them find the exact record.